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JUST VISIBLE above gravel which carried it into River Jordan in Cowichan Copper mine landslide is the rear of company truck lost with three locomotives, machine shop and other supplies Tuesday. Rear wheels can be seen to right of spectator's head. Workmen were diverting flood waters today and hope to have mine back in operation at month-end, president Oswood G. MacDonald said. (Robin Clarke photo.)

Flood Menaces Logging Town

Landslide Jams Jordan River

By AB KENT

Villagers at the tiny west coast logging community of Jordan River today were threatened with flooding after a spectacular landslide at water-filled Cowichan Copper Co. mine.

A hundred thousand cubic yards of mountainside Monday and Tuesday washed into Jordan River in the latest misfortune to strike the mine since Dec. 6.

The silt and gravel being carried downstream filled Canadian Puget Sound Logging Co. booming ground, halting the operation and restricting the river's path to the sea. The booming ground is one mile from the landslide.

HOTEL THREATENED

Flats on the north bank of Jordan River could be inundated, residents feared, perhaps flooding a hotel, restaurant, homes and shops.

The threat was being eased by Canadian Puget Sound bulldozer clearing a channel to tidewater.

Meanwhile, copper mine engineers and miners strove to divert the river from where it wells up to the surface of the mountainside out of control.

Water entered the mine Dec. 6 when part of the river bed collapsed into a mined-out part of the operation, causing the river to flow through the mine works and out the portal, more than 8,000 feet away.

PORTAL BLOCKED

This week, after unusually heavy rains through most of December, the increased flow had carried enough debris with it to block the main portal about 1,500 feet inside.

The water backed up, rising through 250 feet of gravel and finally broke out into the woods. It cascaded down the side hill past the mine office, shops and laboratory, taking staging and loading equipment, and a machine shop down into the river a hundred feet below.

Debris, timber, trees, three small diesel mine locomotives and a truck, supplies and the thousands of yards of gravel and rock raised the riverbed by about 40 feet.

Where the water wells out of the earth is a crater 100 feet wide and 60 feet deep.

Men are trying by today to have this flow diverted about 300 feet to the riverbank, where it can run freely to the sea.

The operation may be a week later in reopening, Cowichan Copper president Oswood G. MacDonald said at the mine.

He expects the original job of stopping the river flow into the mine to be completed within a week or two and the mill operating by the end of January.

The mine won't be closed, he said.

"It is fundamental that we have ore reserves and great potential after that. There is no damage of any consequence to the mill operation although it is flooded temporarily.

"Both this mine and the Sooke area still have potential for mining," he said.

INSURED

The diesels might be worth $20,000, in addition to the $25,000 damage done to the mine earlier.

The rest of the damage has not been assessed, Mr. MacDonald said. Most of the loss will be covered by insurance.

When the operation resumes, the river will have been permanently diverted for about 500 feet where it suddenly poured into the mine.

JANET CREERY
. . . "he was annoyed"

Bank Robber Escapes Police Net

Despite a widespread police search, a man who robbed a bank teller of $33 Tuesday is still at large.

The sneak thief scooped the money from a teller's cage at the Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce at Douglas and Bay. No one noticed the money was gone until after he walked out.

Uniformed police and detectives swarmed over the area within minutes but the man escaped.

Nineteen-year-old Janet Creery said the thief came up to her wicket at about 1 o'clock.

"He had to wait while I attended to a customer ahead of him.

"RATHER RUDE"

"I could see from his nasty expression that he was annoyed being kept waiting. He was rather rude."

The man said he wanted to exchange $70 into U.S. bills. Miss Creery counted out 33 U.S. $1 bills and told him she would have to go to the vault for more U.S. money.

"OK, I'll wait," he said.

When Miss Creery returned she saw the man going out the front door of the bank. She thought he had got fed up

Widow, 75, Year's First Road Victim

A 75-year-old woman was killed on the street almost in front of her home Tuesday night as she returned from her twice-weekly outing for bingo.

Dead is Mrs. Mary Ann Wain, 3864 Douglas, the area's first traffic victim of 1964.

There was a slight drizzle of rain at the time of the mishap, a few doors away from her own home.

Driver of the car was Mrs. Marjorie Greenfield, 49, of 52 Moss.

SWERVED

She told police she did not see Mrs. Wain until the woman suddenly appeared in front of her car. Mrs. Greenfield said she swerved to try and avoid Mrs. Wain.

Police said Mrs. Wain was

All Faiths to Join In Prayer Service

A public service of witness and prayer for Christian unity to which people of all churches will be invited was announced today by the Greater Victoria Council of Churches.

The service will be held in Metropolitan United Church Sunday, Jan. 19, at 3 p.m., and is being sponsored by priests and clergy of the Roman Catholic, Anglican, Baptist, Presbyterian, Lutheran and United churches and the Salvation Army.

Decision to hold the interchurch service was made this morning at a meeting in the YWCA arranged by the Council of Churches and attended by representative clergy.

The meeting followed an hour of prayer and meditation in Christ Church Cathedral conducted by Dean Brian Whitlow.

"We regard this as an important step along the road to Christian unity," said Rev. H. Gordon Walker, chairman of Council of Churches' committee on evangelism and social action.

"We met in an atmosphere of goodwill, charity and forgiveness that augurs well for the future and encourages us to go forward in faith, hope and confidence.

"The fact that our Council of Churches now includes Roman Catholic priests is significant of the present trend.

Mr. Walker said there has been a growing desire for unity among Christian churches over the past 50 years. This has already resulted in the United Church of Canada and more recently in a merger of certain Lutheran synods.

Convention Centre Plan Still Alive

A notice of sale by the Dominion Theatre doesn't mean that plans for a $500,000 convention centre have been scrapped.

The theatre is on the market for $65,000.

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